

Vallabh

Business channel



UptimeLabs

APP 6:09 AM

joined business-comms-6404. Also,
vallabh.vyas
and 28 others joined via invite.



Bez

APP 6:16 AM

Customers have gone outrageous. #OBFail and #OBStealsSale are trending with frustrated posts. We're getting hammered online! Where are we @vallabh.vyas?



vallabh.vyas

APP 6:17 AM

Incident Number INC100069: p1 customer not able completed orders



Bez

APP 6:17 AM

I'm seeing some posts on social media about issues with our platform, is this a regional issue or hitting customers globally?



vallabh.vyas

6:17 AM

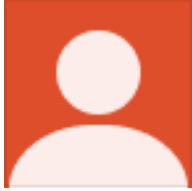
@Bez we have issue in PROD customer are not able to complete the orders

6:17

we are investigating

6:17

will keep you posted



vallabh.vyas

6:23 AM

@Bez User are still able to complete their orders. there are 17% failure out of total request

6:24

its increasing minute by minute



Bez

APP 6:26 AM

Got an email claiming responsibility by "BlackCrow Group" and demanding payment of \$5M in crypto. Honestly, I get these hoax emails all the time, so I'm not buying it



vallabh.vyas

6:27 AM

@Bez This is a ransomware breach



Bez

APP 6:27 AM

Wait! you're telling me this is an actual ransomware hit?

6:27

Alright, tell everyone, no one says a single thing outside online-boutique! I don't care who's asking, not a word until we know exactly what's going on!

6:28

This is nightmare! @vallabh.vyas where are we right now?



vallabh.vyas

6:28 AM

@Bez please change your password. as request by Maya



Bez

APP 6:28 AM

Ok, sure, doing it right now



vallabh.vyas

6:30 AM

@Bez are we paying the ransom or moving with response?



Bez

APP 6:30 AM

Not in favor of paying. Ethically, it sets the wrong example and there's no real guarantee we'll get anything back



1



Tinus

APP 6:30 AM

Agree. Also, just to be clear - we don't need to alert the ICO (Information Commissioner's Office) right this second. We've got up to 72 hours, but that depends on how serious this really is



Bez

APP 6:31 AM

@Tinus do you think this is something we should loop in any cyber security agency for?



Tinus

APP 6:31 AM

If it looks like a complete lock-out, I'd say yes

6:31

We've got Cyvantics Security on retainer - just in case this gets out of hand.
@vallabh.vyas, ask Maya to reach out if needed



vallabh.vyas

6:31 AM

Everyone please update your passwords



Tinus

APP 6:32 AM

I'll do it as well



Bez

APP 6:33 AM

@vallabh.vyas I need a clear answer from the team. What exactly is affected right now?



Tinus

APP 6:33 AM

You're right. We need clear facts - which systems are locked, which are safe



Bez

APP 6:35 AM

Do we have any backup storage? Maybe we can try restoring from that



vallabh.vyas

6:37 AM

@Bez @Tinus this is **Ransomware** attack

Ransomware is a type of cyberattack where attackers encrypt data and demand a ransom for its release. It spreads through phishing emails, compromised software, or exposed services.

- **Attack Source:** Phishing emails, malicious links, third-party software vulnerabilities
- **System Symptoms:** High CPU usage, slow response, .locked or encrypted files, ransom note displayed.
- **Example: WannaCry (2017)** – Affected 200,000+ systems globally, exploiting Windows SMB vulnerability



Bez

APP 6:37 AM

Are we sure about the scope of the infection?



Tinus

APP 6:38 AM

Yes, it's very crucial to be doubly sure about the spread before we do any restoration



vallabh.vyas

6:39 AM

yes @Bez we are following the security playbook

6:40

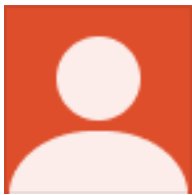
@Bez @Tinus shall we start with restoration now? we have done isolation already



Bez

APP 6:40 AM

Are we seeing any data loss ?



vallabh.vyas

6:41 AM

@Bez checking with team on data loss

6:42

@Bez @Tinus Approximately \$180k worth of order data will be lost since it was not backed up in real-time.



Bez

APP 6:42 AM

Losing this much worth of data isn't good. However we do have insurance, let me check



vallabh.vyas

6:43 AM

shall we continue with restoration now with clean data



Bez

APP 6:43 AM

We're insured for up to \$1M for such losses. Once we're back up, we'll take it forward with the insurer



Tinus

APP 6:43 AM

In that case, we can proceed with the restoration from backup - it's our best option right now



Bez

APP 6:43 AM

Agreed. @vallabh.vyas let's move forward

6:43

Update me as soon as it'll be recovered. Board members are getting impatient



vallabh.vyas

6:47 AM

@Bez restoration is in progress



Bez

APP 6:48 AM

Great, let me know once done



vallabh.vyas

6:49 AM

@Bez restoration is completed. New orders are coming in now. But the customers are asking for refunds who have lost their orders

6:49

what should we do?



Bez

APP 6:49 AM

Keeping it high-level, just say website restored, but there's an issue with few orders. We'll refund them, and customers will get a \$10 gift voucher as an apology



vallabh.vyas

6:53 AM

website is restored @Bez



Bez

APP 6:54 AM

Since services are restored, I'm heading to speak with compliance and the regulators. Thankfully, no data was leaked, that helps



Tinus

APP 6:54 AM

I'm on my way to the ICO (Information Commissioner's Office - UK) office now. I'll get the formal report rolling - that's required for the insurance claim. Keep monitoring in the meantime



vallabh.vyas

6:54 AM

incident is closed @Bez



UptimeLabs

APP 6:55 AM

archived #business-comms-6404. The contents will still be browsable and available in search.



UptimeLabs

APP 6:55 AM

archived #business-comms-6404. The contents will still be browsable and available in search.

Online Boutique



Shay

APP 6:14 AM

Not this time!, I just got a few alerts mentioning severe errors popping up in PROD



Bob

APP 6:14 AM

Weird... a few users just complained they are unable to complete their orders. Feels... off..



Shay

APP 6:14 AM

The alerts have come up again



vallabh.vyas

6:14 AM

@Bob how many user are impacted? is it region specific?



Bob

APP 6:15 AM

Sure, let me look at my reports

6:15

Here are some of the complaints we've received in the last few minutes. It's coming all across the globe

6:15

Germany - "I added items to my cart, clicked checkout, and it just kept spinning. Then it dumped me back to an empty cart"

6:15

USA - "Order failed twice, and now the cart is empty. I refreshed, but now the site is laggy"

6:15

Japan - "Got to checkout, then error 502. Tried again - cart gone"

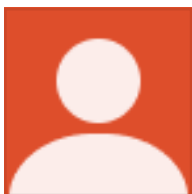
6:15

To sum it all, we have got 240+ reports globally

6:15

(12 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/7csQGjg/Lvl-26-reports-2.webp>



vallabh.vyas

6:15 AM

@Daniel @Shay @Tanya @Hamed S be around we have some PROD issue



Daniel

APP 6:15 AM

Sure



Hamed

APP 6:15 AM

Yes



Tanya

APP 6:15 AM

I'm here



vallabh.vyas

6:16 AM

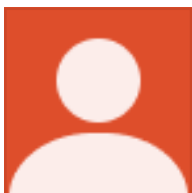
@Daniel @Tanya could you please check the logs.



Shay

APP 6:16 AM

Looking into logs now



vallabh.vyas

6:16 AM

@Shay could you please what was deployed to PROD today just before this alert started coming.



Shay

APP 6:16 AM

Found these below error logs

6:16

app[checkout-service] [ERROR] - write() failed, Read-only filesystem
app[checkout-service] Order submission failed for session_id=ae43f9 due to I/O error
app[checkout-service] [ERROR] - Transaction commit failed, Read-only file system
[ERROR] nginx[3245] - 502 Bad Gateway while accessing upstream checkout service
[ERROR] nginx[3245] - 504 Gateway Timeout while accessing upstream checkout service



Tanya

APP 6:16 AM

Have we raised an incident ?



Shay

APP 6:16 AM

The server is too slow and give up while responding back. I'm not sure why read-only errors are there



Daniel

APP 6:17 AM

Looking at the above logs, app looks fine. But system can't write new data. Errors suggests to be an infra component failure



UptimeLabs

APP 6:17 AM



Incident record created

6:17



Send first comms in first 5 minutes



Daniel

APP 6:17 AM

Also checkout servers show CPU and memory limits exceeded alerts, this definitely looks bigger than just an app issue

6:17

app[checkout-service]: systemd[1][WARN] Resource usage threshold exceeded - CPU: 96%, Memory: 92%



Shay

APP 6:17 AM

Could this be due to load or any changes ?

6:17

<https://uptime-labs.atlassian.net/wiki/external/YzYwYTAxNWQzOTI0NDYzOWI1MjkxNTI2YmVmMjUyZDE>



vallabh.vyas

6:18 AM

@Hamed S @Tanya could you please check this infra issue

6:18

write() failed, Read-only filesystem



Tanya

APP 6:18 AM

Checking infra...

6:19

All four checkout servers are maxed out - CPU, memory, and disk I/O all spiking. No changes or deployments were done from platform side

6:19

(92 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/SwdqW9vX/checkout-servers-spike-simultaneous.webp>

6:19

It doesn't look like a load issue either. CPU and Memory spike is not matching with incoming traffic

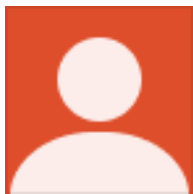
6:19

I'm seeing a running process called init_locker.sh eating up most of the CPU on the checkout server. That's not something we usually run. Something's suspicious here

6:19

(12 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/RtWsqrY/process-Running.webp>



vallabh.vyas

6:20 AM

@Tanya @Hamed S can we spin some more resource to fix this?



Hamed

APP 6:20 AM

Let us try it, but one thing is sure, this is very unusual. Seeing such behavior for the first time



vallabh.vyas

6:20 AM

@Bob i can see still few user are able to order. not all order are failing. can you tell me what is failure and success percentage



Tanya

APP 6:21 AM

I checked our HPA. It has already scaled up to the maximum of our available resources



Bob

APP 6:22 AM

Yes, 17% users have reported it so far



vallabh.vyas

6:22 AM

@Tanya can you check logs for this and confirm its not impacting. **CHG919049**



Tanya

APP 6:22 AM

This change is a non-critical one. It won't break order flow



vallabh.vyas

6:22 AM

@Shay can today changes might have impacted **CHG919047**. could you confirm and check logs once

6:23

@Bob 17% is failure or success?



Shay

APP 6:23 AM

Even recommendation service is a non-critical app



Bob

APP 6:23 AM

Failure

6:23

But its increasing minute by minute



Hamed

APP 6:24 AM

This looks suspicious. We must loop in SecOps into this. And none of the symptoms are aligning with the changes



vallabh.vyas

6:24 AM

@Shay could you please revert your changes



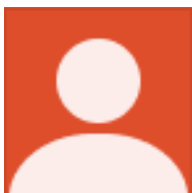
Shay

APP 6:25 AM

Ok let me do it

6:25

Rollback in progress



vallabh.vyas

6:25 AM

@Maya we have PROD issue. looks like DDOS attack. could you please check and confirm from your side



Shay

APP 6:25 AM

I've reverted my change. How's it now @vallabh.vyas ?



Maya

APP 6:25 AM

Let me check if there's anything suspicious



vallabh.vyas

6:26 AM

checking @Shay



Maya

APP 6:26 AM

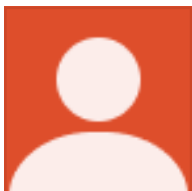
Weird!! Security agent known as EDR(Endpoint Detection and Response) is missing from all 4 checkout servers. That's? concerning

6:26

EDR is basically our endpoint defense tool, it tracks unusual activity at the servers

6:26

Also,I found an init_locker.sh script encrypting DB, app, and log files which is renaming the filename like below



vallabh.vyas

6:26 AM

@Bob is there any improvment



Maya

APP 6:26 AM

order_log_2025-06-01.locked
session_state.tmp.locked



Daniel

APP 6:26 AM

this explains why there were errors in checkout logs saying write failed , read-only filesystem



Tanya

APP 6:26 AM

Wait... there's a file here named HELP_ME_DECRYPT.txt. I opened it, appears a ransom note. This doesn't look good

6:26

(27 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/HDcr1Rzb/ransomnote.webp>



Maya

APP 6:26 AM

Confirmed. This is a ransomware breach. @vallabh.vyas inform business about this



Bob

APP 6:26 AM

Nope, complaints have gone up to affecting 27% of our users now



Tanya

APP 6:26 AM

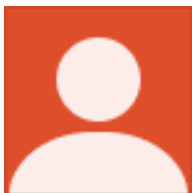
Shall i try killing this script ?



Bob

APP 6:26 AM

Guys!!! User complaints are sky rocketing, its turning catastrophic!



vallabh.vyas

6:27 AM

@Maya can we restore everything from our backup.



Maya

APP 6:27 AM

Killing the script could make things worse, higher ransom or losing data forever

6:28

@vallabh.vyas before we do anything, I'd request everyone to please change their passwords

6:28

Also I'm removing everyone's access to servers - only I'll have control for now. Later we will reassess to do any activity further



Daniel

APP 6:28 AM

Done on my end



Hamed

APP 6:28 AM

Updated. @Maya smart move by limiting server's access



Shay

APP 6:28 AM

Password updated



Bob

APP 6:28 AM

Changed mine too. Better safe than sorry



Maya

APP 6:28 AM

Yes, i do have a plan to mitigate this



Tanya

APP 6:28 AM

All set

6:28

It's much worse now. Every file I check is encrypted, nothing can be opened or recovered.



Shay

APP 6:28 AM

I'm seeing new errors on frontend now. How's it for you @vallabh.vyas ?



Maya

APP 6:28 AM

Attention! when it comes to potential security breaches, it's important we don't discuss sensitive details here

6:28

I'm setting up private channel...

6:28

@vallabh.vyas before we move to private channel, can you check with business what's the plan - are we paying the ransom or moving with response?



vallabh.vyas

6:29 AM

Sure Maya. please create private channel checking with bussiness

6:30

@Shay for me website is loading. I am getting error message on checkout - Unable to process new requests due to system degradation.



Maya

APP 6:30 AM

Yeah, meanwhile I'm creating the chat



Shay

APP 6:30 AM

Yes same for me as well



Maya

APP 6:31 AM

Lets move to private channel @vallabh.vyas



Bob

APP 6:35 AM

@vallabh.vyas user complaints are spiking. They're reporting the site is down, earlier it wasn't the case. What should I tell them now?



UptimeLabs

APP 6:49 AM



- You have less than 5 minutes. You can type /help if you need any reminders.



Maya

APP 6:51 AM

Do we go ahead and mark this incident as closed?



vallabh.vyas

6:52 AM

@Bob We'll refund them, and customers will get a \$10 gift voucher as an apology



Bob

APP 6:52 AM

Thanks @vallabh.vyas



UptimeLabs

APP 6:52 AM



- You have less than 2 minutes. You can type /help if you need any reminders.



vallabh.vyas

6:52 AM

@Maya we need investigate on that email template correct?



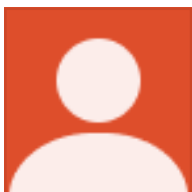
Maya

APP 6:52 AM

Yes , we will do it more in PIR

6:53

People need to be aware about not clicking on any malicious email or links



vallabh.vyas

6:53 AM

does it does not need immediate attention @Maya? can we close this incident?



Maya

APP 6:53 AM

i've blocked the email domain



1



Tanya

APP 6:54 AM

That was intense. We've never been this close to total loss before. We got lucky



Daniel

APP 6:54 AM

Systems are calm now, but that feeling earlier... not something I want to go through again



Bob

APP 6:54 AM

One small slip caused a major breach. We need better awareness to prevent this in future



Tinus

APP 6:54 AM

This could've gone way worse. Appreciate how quickly and cleanly you handled it



Bez

APP 6:54 AM

Not every day we survive an attack like this. You made the right calls, fast. Great job, @vallabh.vyas - that's how we bounce back

Private Channel



UptimeLabs

APP 6:09 AM

joined private-comms-6404. Also, Hamed S and 20 others joined via invite.



Maya

APP 6:31 AM

@vallabh.vyas let's build the core response team here. I've already added myself. Who else should we pull in to keep it tight and efficient?

6:31

I'd say one senior person each from security, platform, and engineering. Also add Tanya, tasks could be platform intensive



vallabh.vyas

6:32 AM

@Maya we are not paying them



Maya

APP 6:32 AM

This is great. Then lets tag Daniel, Hamed and Tanya in here



vallabh.vyas

6:32 AM

@Maya lets add @Tanya @Bob @Hamed S @Daniel



Tanya

APP 6:33 AM

was added to private-comms-6404 by vallabh.vyas

. Also,
Bob
and

Daniel
joined via invite.



Maya

APP 6:33 AM

Yes, we've got an IR(incident response) retainer with Cyvantics Security



vallabh.vyas

6:33 AM

@Maya what are the next steps?



Maya

APP 6:33 AM

Looped in Cyvantics Security - they're on their way now to take snapshots of the infected server and storage, followed by forensics on it

6:33

Meanwhile, I've got this from Cyvantics. @vallabh.vyas, can you help track the steps and coordinate?

6:33

<https://uptime-labs.atlassian.net/wiki/external/MThjMTk4ZDU5ODU0NGZmMWE1NzhmNGY0MDQwNWI1NTA>

6:33

We've got isolation steps in the playbook, but before we dive in, can you paste that list here? I'll help team run through it



vallabh.vyas

6:34 AM

Steps for Isolation:

Steps to be done, mentioned along with the **owning** team

1. Disconnect the infected server -> Platforms
2. Cut off infrastructure traffic -> Platforms
3. Disconnect DB & freeze backup -> Application

4. Detach from Shared Resource -> Platforms
5. Take snapshots (Disk & Memory) -> Ask team
6. Kill suspicious process or activity -> Platforms

Steps for Restoration:

Steps to be done, mentioned along with the **owning** team

1. Validate backups → Security
2. Wipe infected systems → Platforms
3. Rebuild from clean backup → Platforms
4. Re-enable security agent on the servers → Security
5. Reconnect traffic to services and monitor → Platforms



Maya

APP 6:35 AM

I've given write access to Tanya, Hamed, Daniel, and myself



Tanya

APP 6:35 AM

Disconnecting the checkout servers from the infra now



Daniel

APP 6:35 AM

I'm on it. Disconnecting DB access for checkout and checking if scheduled backups exist



Hamed

APP 6:35 AM

I'll verify if any shared storage is still attached to the checkout DB



vallabh.vyas

6:35 AM

@Maya @Hamed S can we please start doing this above mentioned activity



Daniel

APP 6:35 AM

Step 3 done, DB connection to checkout is now cut



Tanya

APP 6:35 AM

Step 1 done, Checkout servers are now fully disconnected. Moving to isolate the infra from all external traffic



Hamed

APP 6:35 AM

Step 4 confirmed, No shared storage attached to checkout, which makes sense since checkout has its standalone storage



Tanya

APP 6:35 AM

Step 2 completed, Infra is now fully cut off from the outside world. That means the website will remain completely down until we recover



Maya

APP 6:35 AM

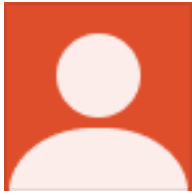
Step 5 done, Cyvantics has completed taking snapshots of the checkout servers and database. They've now moved on to forensics. @Hamed, we're good to kill the script now



Hamed

APP 6:36 AM

Step 6 done, The Script has been killed. @vallabh.vyas let us know and double-check if anything else is pending on our side



vallabh.vyas

6:36 AM

@Maya @Daniel @Hamed S have we completed all 6 **ISOLATION** steps?



Maya

APP 6:36 AM

Yes all the steps are done for isolation



vallabh.vyas

6:38 AM

@Maya @Daniel @Hamed S can we start Restoration now. based on dependency first. lets complete all the points



Maya

APP 6:38 AM

Yes, we must have a backup. Platform team can confirm us



Hamed

APP 6:38 AM

Correct, we do have backup which only runs at 2AM. Latest is yesterday's. We'll lose today's orders



Maya

APP 6:38 AM

Isolation is complete. We're good to move toward restoration using the backup storage now

6:38

@vallabh.vyas could you please confirm with business before moving forward on this

6:38

I've called in @Bob to the channel



Bob

APP 6:38 AM

@vallabh.vyas, I hear you need my help, what exactly should I look into?

6:39

With the sale starting today, the potential loss is significant - around \$180k



vallabh.vyas

6:39 AM

@Bob what is failure percentage now?



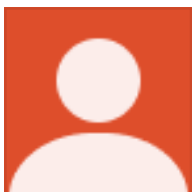
Bob

APP 6:39 AM

The complete site is down, so 100% users are impacted as of now



1



vallabh.vyas

6:40 AM

@Maya backup does not have any malicious code. could you please confirm

6:41

@Bob @Maya how much percentage of data loss we are expecting?



Maya

APP 6:41 AM

I've got in touch with Cyvantics, they confirmed that backup is clean and only checkout got infected. There are no signs of lateral movement



1

6:42

Approximately \$180k worth of order data will be lost since it was not backed up in real-time.



vallabh.vyas

6:43 AM

@Daniel @Hamed S @Maya we can continue with all restoration points. confirmed with business



Maya

APP 6:44 AM

Thanks for the go-ahead. @vallabh.vyas, please track all restoration steps

6:44

I'm now validating the backup storage to ensure it's safe



Hamed

APP 6:44 AM

I'm provisioning new checkout servers, will update once ready



Maya

APP 6:44 AM

Backup is clean and safe. @Hamed, you can start rebuilding checkout from backup storage



Hamed

APP 6:44 AM

Thanks, Maya. New servers are ready. I'll start rebuilding now using backup storage

6:44

Rebuild completed



vallabh.vyas

6:44 AM

@Bob just keep an eye on order once restoration completes



Maya

APP 6:44 AM

I've enabled the security agents (EDR) on checkout servers



Daniel

APP 6:44 AM

I'll monitor application health once services are restored



Maya

APP 6:44 AM

@vallabh.vyas , can you confirm all tasks are wrapped up and we are good to bring the traffic back? Just want to be sure, as this is the final restoration step before we move



Bob

APP 6:45 AM

Sure



vallabh.vyas

6:45 AM

@Maya @Daniel @Hamed S have we completed all 6 step mentioned in **RESTORATION**



Hamed

APP 6:45 AM

No wait



vallabh.vyas

6:45 AM

@Bob can you check on order. are you seeing any failures?



Hamed

APP 6:46 AM

I'm wiping up infected systems

6:46

Yes its done now



vallabh.vyas

6:46 AM

ok @Hamed S @Daniel 502 Bad Gateway

6:46

are you also seeing this?



Maya

APP 6:46 AM

@vallabh.vyas yes we're good to bring up the traffic now



Daniel

APP 6:47 AM

Yes because complete infra was cut off during isolation



vallabh.vyas

6:47 AM

@Hamed S @Maya can we do the live traffic routing



Tanya

APP 6:47 AM

Thanks for the go ahead. Bringing up network traffic in progress...



Hamed

APP 6:47 AM

Tanya is doing it



Tanya

APP 6:47 AM

Restoration completed



vallabh.vyas

6:48 AM

@Bob @Daniel can you check on ORders



Bob

APP 6:48 AM

Wait!! getting a bunch of new complaints now. Users are neither able to see their return requests nor able to place new returns on the site



Maya

APP 6:48 AM

Yeah, that's probably the missing today's checkout data. Anyone who ordered or returned something during that time won't see it - makes sense since we restored from the yesterday's backup



Tanya

APP 6:48 AM

Tough, but expected :)



vallabh.vyas

6:48 AM

@Bob are you seeing any failures now?



Bob

APP 6:48 AM

What should I tell them? They are asking for refunds

6:48

New orders are coming in now

6:48

But the customers are asking for refunds who have lost their orders



vallabh.vyas

6:49 AM

@Bob let me check with bussiness on this.



Daniel

APP 6:49 AM

Order metrics are going up which means new orders are coming in



1



Maya

APP 6:50 AM

@vallabh.vyas I've received the forensics report from Cyvantics Security



vallabh.vyas

6:50 AM

thanks @Daniel



Maya

APP 6:50 AM

(85 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/q3Jp58dv/CONFIDENTIAL-6-page-0001.webp>

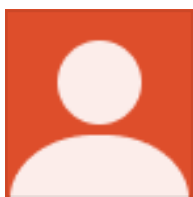
6:50

Also, I just finished combing through Shay's mailbox. There's something important here, I found two emails from what looks like our monitoring vendor - ClearTech

6:50

(103 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/VpLJHh7y/CT-20250829-055655-0000.webp>



vallabh.vyas

6:50 AM

@Maya is it looking good. or any more action on us?



Maya

APP 6:50 AM

Systems are stable now

6:50

We will take this forward in PIR , for now website is restored

6:50

No more actions apart from futher monitoring

6:50

Alright, since everything's back up and stable, we can now move back to the main #online-boutique channel. No further actions left here



vallabh.vyas

6:51 AM

@Daniel @Shay could you please looking into this email template and provide hot fix



UptimeLabs

APP 6:55 AM

archived #private-comms-6404. The contents will still be browsable and available in search.